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Dane County Board votes to cut funding for Flock license-plate reader cameras

Chair says Board open to considering alternative ALPR systems

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A Flock Safety automated license plate reader (ALPR) camera and solar panel mounted on a light pole in N
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The Dane County Board has voted to remove funding from the Sheriff's Office for use of its Flock Safety automated license plate reader system (ALPR) and prohibit further spending on the system.

According to a Dane County Board news release, on April 16, the Board voted to amend the 2026 county budget — which had included \$80,000 for the annual Flock subscription — to remove that funding. The current subscription runs through May 31.

Area law enforcement's use of Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) cameras				
Jurisdiction	Provider	Year started	Fixed-location cameras currently in use	Cameras being added
Cambridge*	none			
Columbia Sheriff	Flock, Neology	2020	17	–
Cottage Grove	Flock	2022	7	2
Dane Sheriff	Flock	2022	24	–
Deerfield*	none			
DeForest	none			
Dodge Sheriff	Flock	2022 or 2023	17	–
Fort Atkinson	none			
Jefferson Sheriff	Flock	2025	7	3 (budgeted)
Jefferson	Flock	2025	6	going down to 2
Johnson Creek	none			
Lake Mills	Flock	starting in 2026	–	2
Lodi	Flock	2023 (for Flock)	3**	2 with live video
Madison	none***			
Marshall	Flock	2024	2	3 (budgeted)
McFarland	Flock	starting in 2026	–	6
Middleton	Flock	2013	3	
Monona	Flock	2023	3	1
Poynette	Flock	2024 ?	1	in-squad ALPRs
Sun Prairie	Flock	Dec. 2023	6	3
Waterloo	none			
Watertown	Flock	2021 or 2022	"less than 10"	plan to add cameras to reach total of 10-20 in 2026
Waunakee	Flock	2024	5	–
Whitewater	Flock	2023	13	–
Windsor*	cameras installed by Dane County Sheriff's Office			
Wis. State Patrol	in-squad****			
UW-Madison Police	Flock	2025	8	–

* According to Dane County Sheriff's Office Captain Kerry Porter, they have cameras near Deerfield and Cambridge, but not directly in either village. The Windsor cameras are part of the 24 total.

** Lodi also has 2 non-Flock cameras in partnership with Columbia County

*** While Madison Police Department says it "has not adopted Flock or similar open network camera systems," State Capitol Police use Flock ALPR cameras around Capitol Square and UW-Madison Police use them in the campus area

**** While the Wisconsin State Patrol says it does not use Flock cameras, it did activate Axon in-car camera systems in law enforcement vehicles in 2025, which use ALPR technology. There are currently about 400 users at this time, it said. There are also six mounted ALPR cameras at its Safety and Weight Enforcement Facilities (SWEFs) and two at virtual weigh stations for commercial motor vehicle inspections, it said.

(Source: Email inquiries to area law enforcement)

Area law enforcement's use of Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) cameras (PDF file of the table)

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Chris Lee

